

# In Step

One of three shortlisted December 2026 CEA links, in ten minutes

For managers · 26 weeks · code IS-26-T4 · Even Step is the recommended design

# The short version

Four numbers

| 9 of 9 | 35h | 0 | 26 |
| --- | --- | --- | --- |
| **December staffing rules met** | **contracted hours a week** | **avoidable fatigue warnings** | **people on the link** |
| today 4 of 9 | Mon–Sat average | cover weeks aside | today 20 |

**Every December staffing rule met — and the steadiest weekly hours of the three.**

# The staffing you asked for

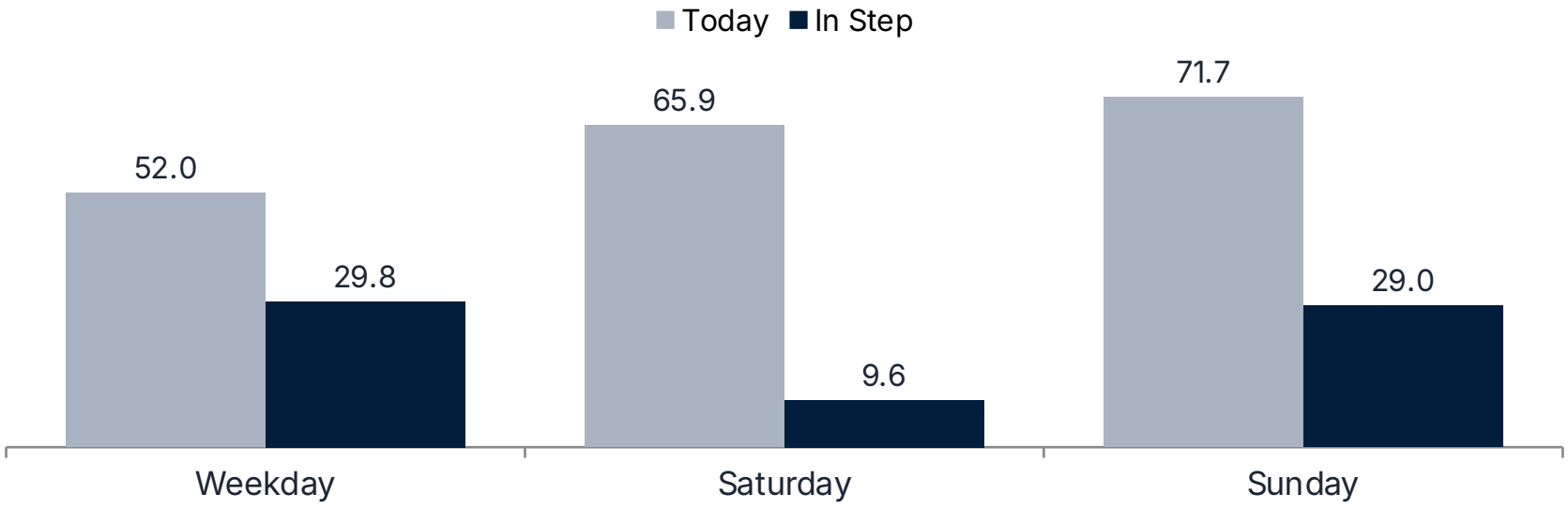
Each figure reads weekday · Saturday · Sunday

| | Today | In Step |
|---|---|---|
| On duty each day (Sunday: at least 10) | 11–12 · 10 · 8 | **15 · 14 · 10** |
| At the open, at least 4 (06:20, Sun 07:15) | 4 · 4 · 3 | **5 · 5 · 4** |
| Still on duty at 22:00, at least 5 | 4 · 2 · 3 | **7 · 5 · 5** |
| Through to the close, at least 3 | 2 · 2 · 3 | **3 · 3 · 3** |
| Fewest on the floor at any time, at least 2 | 2 · 2 · 2 | **3 · 3 · 3** |

**Every level met on every day — and the ticket office staffed in pairs, including Sundays.**

# People where the trains are

Fit to the trains: floor staff against the December trains, hour by hour — lower is better




**Staffing follows the December trains more closely every day — far more at weekends.**

# People and hours

What it takes to run

| | Today | In Step |
|---|---|---|
| People on the link | 20 | **26** |
| Contracted hours a week | 35h | **35h** |
| Cover weeks (for leave and sickness) | 4 of 20 (20%) | **5 of 26 (19%)** |
| People needed each Sunday (overtime) | 8 | **10** |

**Six more people, the same 35-hour week — and Sundays are still worked as overtime.**

# Fatigue checks

Office of Rail and Road and rail-industry good practice — not a fatigue risk assessment

| | Today | In Step |
|---|---|---|
| Avoidable fatigue warnings, cover weeks aside | 4 (up to 5) | **0 (up to 1)** |
| Most days in a row (limit 13) | 7 (up to 9) | **5 (up to 7)** |
| Shortest rest between shifts (limit 12h) | 12h 30m | **14h 35m** |
| Longest shift, any day | 9h 10m | **9h 00m** |

**Rest and days-in-a-row limits met with room to spare. In brackets: the worst case, if a cover week falls badly.**

# Why In Step?

What all three shortlisted links give, what this one adds, and what it costs

- ✓ All three: all 9 December rules; no avoidable fatigue warning, cover weeks aside
- ✓ All three: 14 full weekends off a year each (today 10), at most 5 weeks apart
- ✓ All three: no shift over 9 hours, and every closing shift shorter
- ✓ This one adds: steadiest weeks, closest Saturday fit, most early finishes of the three
- ✓ Shift times: 15 (today 18), 9 of them worked today
- – This one costs: the most long weekday earlies, about 40 a year each over 8h 30m

**What all three cost: more late finishes, two more Saturdays a year, a day more leave for four weeks off.**

# What colleagues will notice

The three biggest gains and costs, per person, cover weeks aside

## Likely to welcome

- **More weekends off**
  14 full weekends a year, not 10
- **Fewer days in a row**
  5 at most, not 7
- **Shorter closing shifts**
  every one 30 to 60 minutes shorter

## Likely to worry about

- **More late finishes**
  94 a year at 22:00 or later, not 78
- **Longer weekday earlies**
  up to 8h 55m, not 8h 30m
- **Less premium and overtime pay**
  about £250 a year, gross, for a full share of Sundays

**Expect late finishes and long earlies first — the colleague presentation answers both.**

# Where it stands

Three things settled, two decisions left, two points still open

- ✓ **December rules — confirmed verbally**
  Everything here is built on them; worth having in writing before a link is chosen.
- ✓ **26 people on the link — decided**
  Six more than today, with five cover weeks.
- ✓ **Sunday cover — confirmed verbally**
  Ten on a Sunday — Sunday work stays overtime.
- ? **To decide: which link we use**
  After colleagues' views. Not yet seen by the roster office or a union rep.
- ? **Then: who starts on which line**
  Decided after the link is chosen.

**Still open: where the 13-day limit is written; how one fatigue check treats a rest day.**



# The detail

- Every week of the link, day by day
- Staff on duty hour by hour, against the trains
- Every December rule and fatigue check, worked through

All in the eight-page proposal sheet · In Step · IS-26-T4 · 8d9239f3